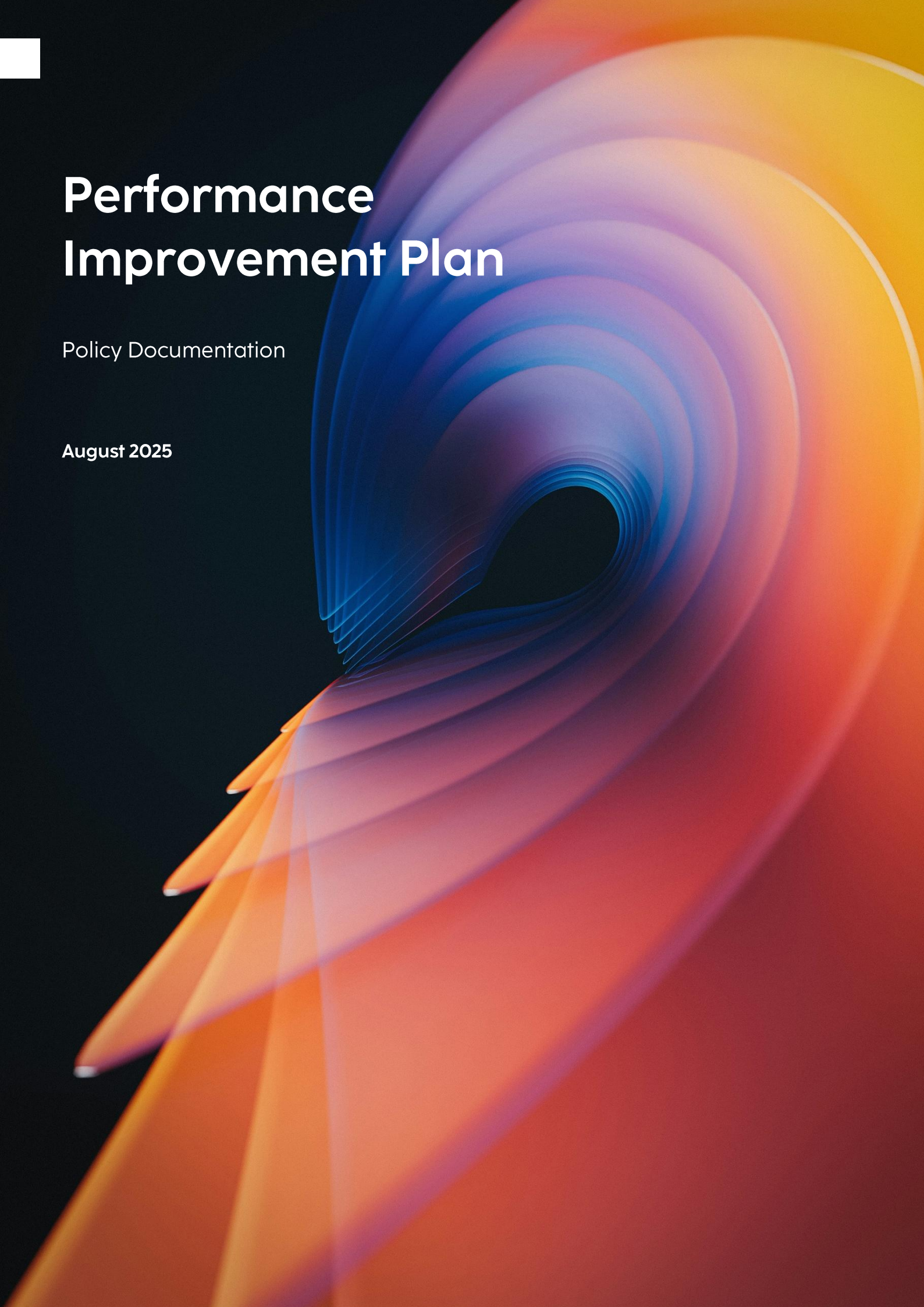




Performance Improvement Plan

Policy Documentation

August 2025

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1 PURPOSE

This document outlines the governance, structure, and step-by-step implementation procedures for the Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) at Engineering Albania. A PIP serves as a formalized mechanism to address employee performance gaps through structured support, coaching, and review. The intent is to foster a fair, consistent, and transparent performance culture.

2 CONTEXT AND SCOPE

This policy applies to all employees at Engineering Albania who have completed their probationary period and are underperforming or misaligned with role expectations. Areas addressed include:

- Performance shortfalls
- Behavioral concerns
- Procedural non-compliance
- Role misalignment
- Technical competencies

The PIP is a tool for structured development, not immediate discipline. It is meant to offer an improvement plan to employees, where certain gaps are identified. As such, it also exists in Workday and is directly linked to the performance review process. It is made bilingual, to ensure clear understanding of all parties.

3 POLICY GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK

The PIP policy follows these guiding principles:

Feedback First: Employees must receive informal coaching and feedback before any formal PIP is initiated.

SMART Goal Structure: PIP objectives must be Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound.

HR Oversight: HR must be involved throughout to ensure legal defensibility and fairness.

Managerial Engagement: Line managers are responsible for continuous coaching and documentation.

4 PIP LIFECYCLE AND PROCEDURES

This section outlines the end-to-end process for initiating, managing, and concluding a PIP.

Identify Performance Issues

Responsibility: Team Lead (TL) and / or Functional Lead

TL identifies performance concerns based on objective observations, results, or receives feedback from Functional Lead. (e.g., quality of work, missed deadlines, behavioral issues).

Provide Informal Feedback

- **Responsibility:** TL
- Deliver verbal and/or written feedback to the employee. Offer coaching or support to address the concern.



If the issue persists TL starts the PIP process

Gather Technical & Project Feedback

Responsibility: Functional Leads / Project Manager — requested by TL

TL formally requests written feedback from the relevant functional lead(s) and Project TL. This feedback should include specific examples, impact on work or project outcomes, and suggested development actions.

Timeline: requested feedback should be submitted within **3 business days** of the TL's request (or sooner depending on urgency).

Conduct Preliminary Discussion

- **Responsibility:** TL
- Have a formal discussion with the employee outlining specific concerns and expectations for improvement.
- Agree the PIP completion timeline – typically, three months, but could be shorter in some instances

Consult HR

- **Responsibility:** TL
- Email HR with:
 - Summary of performance concerns
 - Evidence of previous feedback/coaching
 - Justification for initiating a PIP
- **HR Role:** Confirm alignment with policy and assist in structuring the plan.

Draft and Finalize PIP Document

- **Responsibility:** TL and HR
- Create the PIP with the following components:
 - Performance issues and supporting evidence
 - SMART objectives for improvement
 - Action items (e.g., training, coaching, resources)
 - Timeline (4 weeks)
 - Weekly or biweekly review schedule
 - Consequences of not meeting expectations

PIP Acknowledgment and Activation

- Employees must review; ensure they understand content, acknowledge and sign the PIP within **3 business days**.
- Signatures required: Employee, TL, ~~HR~~.

Implementation and Ongoing Input

Responsibility: Employee, TL, Functional Leads, Project TL, HR

- All parties follow the plan and complete ~~s~~-agreed actions.
- TL holds bi-weekly check-ins to monitor progress and provide coaching.
- Functional leads remain available to provide technical mentoring, additional feedback, or progress observations when asked by the TL or HR. Their input should be documented in the check-in notes when relevant.



Midpoint Review

Responsibility: TL and HR, Functional Leads (as needed)

- Conducted at 50% of the PIP duration.
- TL evaluates progress against SMART objectives and requests written feedback from the technical leads.
- HR should be present if concerns remain or if changes to scope/timeline are considered.

Final Review and Outcome

- At conclusion of the PIP timeline:
 - **Successful Completion:** Employee met all expectations; return to regular performance management.
 - **Partial Completion:** Improvement shown but not fully adequate; PIP may be extended once.
 - **Unsuccessful Completion:** Performance remains unsatisfactory; proceed with formal consequences (e.g., termination) in consultation with HR.

Final Communication

- TL and HR hold a formal meeting with the employee.
- Communicate the outcome and next steps.
- All documentation is finalized and filed with HR.

5 ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Manager / Team Lead (TL):

- Identify issues and initiate feedback
- Engage HR and draft the PIP
- Conduct reviews and provide support
- Track metrics and document progress

Functional Leads & Project Team Lead (Project TL):

- Provide timely, specific, and evidence-based feedback on technical performance, project delivery, and collaboration. This includes:
 - Early feedback that may inform the TL's decision to initiate a PIP.
 - Ongoing input and technical mentoring during the PIP period.
 - Final technical assessment for the midpoint and closure phases when relevant.

Employee:

- Participate actively in the process
- Attend all check-ins and complete assigned actions
- Communicate needs and request support where necessary

HR Department:

- Ensure procedural fairness and compliance
- Review all documentation and guide the process



- Attend midpoint/final reviews as needed
- Validate and record outcomes

6 FINAL NOTES

This policy is effective as of August 2025. Engineering Albania reserves the right to revise, update, or revoke any part of this policy in accordance with legal requirements and business needs.

Employees are encouraged to view the PIP process as a supportive mechanism for improvement rather than punishment. When executed transparently and constructively, PIPs promote accountability, engagement, and professional growth.

